



China consumer

EQUITY: CONSUMER RELATED

Nanjing-based mall records mixed performances by brands

Expert on shopping malls saw divergent performances by luxury/jewelry brands in 2Q26

We hosted a channel check call (24 June) with an expert with deep knowledge of China's high-end consumption trend, who provided observations on a leading luxury shopping mall, located in Nanjing of Jiangsu Province. Our key takeaways from the call are summarised below:

2Q26 sales saw sequential weakening from 1Q26

According to the expert, the shopping mall's sales performance during quarter-to-date (QTD) 2Q26 saw some sequential weakening from 1Q26 (historically the peak season with the Chinese New Year holiday). As per the expert, in 2Q26, the shopping mall's total foot traffic grew by c.10% y-y, and total sales value grew by mid-single-digit% (MSD%) y-y.

Although there was a strong recovery in foot traffic in QTD 2Q26, the expert noted that consumers are more focused on experience-related consumptions; the mall has utilized several key promotional windows (such as the Labor Day holiday, the "520" celebration and the shopping mall's 20th year anniversary) to stimulate more experience-focused purchases by consumers, as per the expert.

Mixed performance by major segments and brands

Based on the expert's comments, there were divergent sales performances across major consumption segments in QTD 2Q26.

- Gold & jewelry: the expert has a long-run bullish view on the gold & jewelry segment and believes that China's consumers will have sustained demand for well-crafted, premium jewelry and collectibles in the long run, with the segment being one of the most promising luxury categories. According to the expert, global leading jewelry brands such as Van Cleef & Arpels [owned by Richemont (CFR SW, Not rated)] has continued its strong sales momentum with double-digit% y-y SSS growth in 2Q26, and the y-y decline in SSSG of Cartier (also owned by Richemont) has also narrowed in 2Q26 from 1Q26. Meanwhile, the expert noted that domestic premium jewelry brand Laopu Gold (6181 HK, Buy) saw certain moderation in sales growth, delivering 40-50% y-y SSS growth in 2Q26 (compared with >70% y-y SSS growth in 1Q26). According to the expert, the slowdown in Laopu's sales momentum was mainly due to: 1) increasingly fierce competition in the specific shopping mall as more gold jewelry brands were introduced; and 2) weaker consumer sentiment due to falling gold prices.
- Luxury brands: the expert also noted mixed performance among global luxury brands in QTD 2Q26 at the specific shopping mall. According to the expert, Dior [owned by LVMH (MC FP, Not rated)] saw clear signs of a recovery, while sales growth momentum of Hermès (RMS FP, Not rated), Louis Vuitton (owned by LVMH), and Chanel (unlisted) remained stable in 2Q26. However, other luxury brands still witnessed downward sales trends in 2Q26 in the specific shopping mall, according to the expert.

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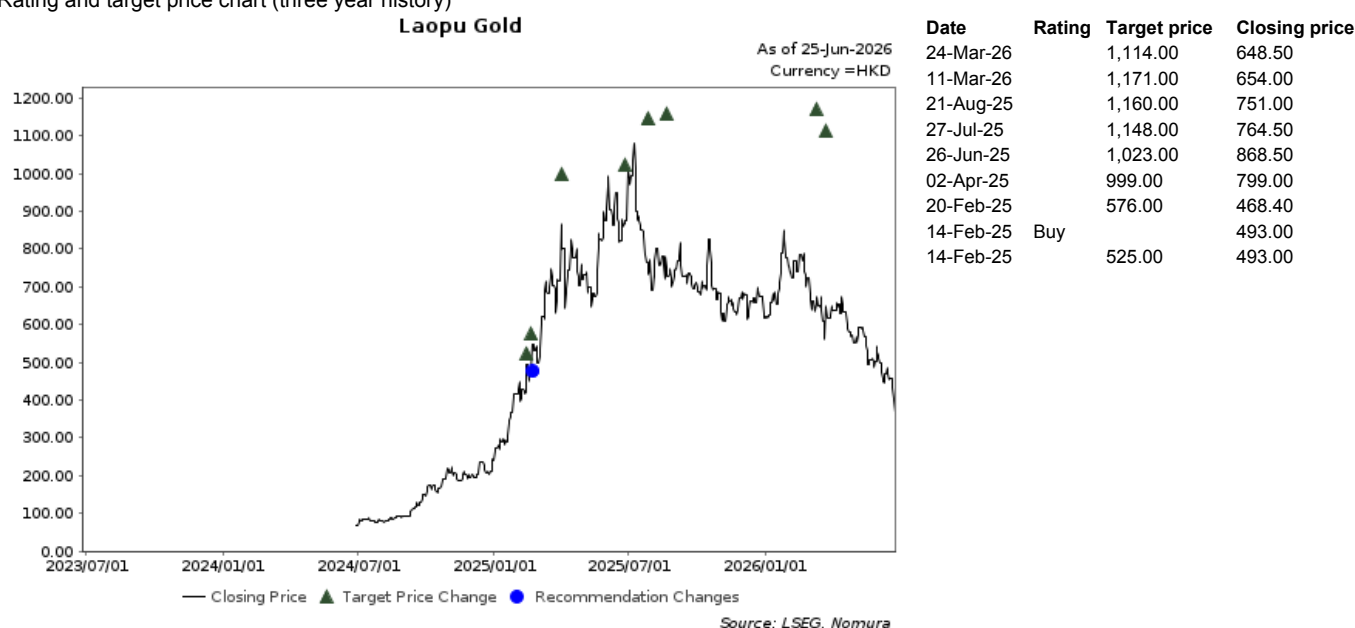
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Issuer	Ticker	Price	Price date	Stock rating	Sector rating	Disclosures
Laopu Gold	6181 HK	HKD 367.80	25-Jun-2026	Buy	N/A	

Laopu Gold (6181 HK)

HKD 367.80 (25-Jun-2026) Buy (Sector rating: N/A)

Rating and target price chart (three year history)



For explanation of ratings refer to the stock rating keys located after chart(s)

Valuation Methodology Our target price of HKD1,114 is based on 22.5x FY26F P/E, consistent with Laopu's high sales and earnings growth trajectory. The benchmark index for the company is the Hang Seng Index.

Risks that may impede the achievement of the target price Key downside risks include: 1) any significant weakening of gold price, 2) higher-than-expected fashion risk, 3) weaker-than-expected macro environment.

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